"SOLUTIONS IN INDIA CAN BE TEMPLATES FOR GLOBAL SOUTH"

Irina Ghose, Managing Director, Anthropic India, on AI adoption, building trust and what women working at the cutting edge of technology bring to the table

BY **PALAK AGARWAL**

AS ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE (AI) moves from experimentation to enterprise-wide adoption, businesses must look beyond increasingly capable models to address trust, safety, data governance and measurable value. These are particularly significant in India given its vast technology ecosystem, diverse needs and potential to develop AI solutions at population scale.

For Anthropic, the company behind Claude, which identifies India as its second-largest market, building a presence goes beyond market expansion. It involves helping enterprises modernise, partnering with Indian IT services firms to develop AI-powered solutions, supporting developers and exploring applications across sectors such as education, healthcare and life sciences. Local inference capabilities are also expected to address data processing and governance needs, particularly in regulated industries.

Irina Ghose, who is spearheading Anthropic's India business, has moved into the faster-moving environment of a global AI company after more than two decades at Microsoft. As she speaks about Anthropic's India ambitions, she appears visibly excited. Her leadership in steering Anthropic's India expansion has also earned her recognition as a Super Achiever in Business Today's Most Powerful Women list, underscoring her growing influence in shaping India's AI landscape.

In this conversation with Business Today, she discusses Anthropic's India strategy, the role of partnerships in accelerating enterprise adoption, the importance of responsible AI development and opportunities for India to shape how AI is built and used globally. Edited excerpts.

> INDIA WAS CHOSEN BECAUSE IT DEEPLY ALIGNS WITH ANTHROPIC'S MISSION. AS A PUBLIC-BENEFIT COMPANY FOCUSED ON GLOBAL GOOD, ANTHROPIC ALIGNS WITH INDIA'S AMBITION TO DRIVE NUANCED USE CASES FOR THE LAST MILE"

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How has been the journey of building Anthropic India from scratch after coming from an established business like Microsoft?

It has been very interesting. At Microsoft, where I spent more than two decades, I was involved in early stages of shipping as we moved into cloud, established AI initiatives and built the business around them. At Anthropic, a global start-up, the pace, mindset and everything else are very different.

First, there is no playbook. You might think you can replicate what worked in other organisations, but here you have to write the